



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: The Ambrose School

School Website: <https://theambroseschool.org>

December 27, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Ambrose School Id 83646 presents a robust Classical Christian profile across all six rubric categories. The public materials consistently foreground Christ-centered formation, virtue and memory work, disciplined study of the liberal arts, and explicit engagement with teachers, families, and a shared community life. Evidence includes direct references to K-12 classical Christian education, liturgical practices such as prayer and hymns, and a clear emphasis on Great Books/Great Conversation through curriculum pathways and faculty development. Notably, Ambrose explicitly codifies Socratic pedagogy in upper grades via a dedicated Socratic Discussion Practicum and maintains a deliberate program structure that integrates Latin, logic, rhetoric, and moral formation through both classroom and co-curricular activities. These signals collectively align with the six-element classical rubric at a strong to full-classical level.

- **Religious and Metaphysical Foundations:** Strongly CLASSICAL. The site emphasizes Christ-centered learning, theology-integration, liturgical practices, and explicit church affiliations among staff and leadership. See evidence of liturgical practices (prayer, hymn, Bible stories) and Christ-centered framing in staff and program materials.
- **Purpose and Goal:** Strongly CLASSICAL. Emphasis on formation, virtue, wisdom, and a transcendent view of truth/goodness/beauty is explicit in leadership and staff narratives.
- **Curriculum:** CLASSICAL. Evidence of grammar/logic/rhetoric orientation, Latin, Great Books/primary texts through linked curriculum resources, and Great-Conversation framing via curriculum partners. Memorization/recitation and liturgical memory work further anchor classical aims.
- **Pedagogy:** CLASSICAL. A defined progression from grammar to logic to rhetoric, with concrete examples of Socratic discussion practices and memory-based pedagogy (recitation, chant) evidenced in staff trainings and classroom materials.
- **Faculty:** CLASSICAL. Faculty biographies and leadership describe mentors, living curriculum, and teacher exemplars; staff narratives emphasize virtue, formation, and partnership with families.
- **Parents & Community:** CLASSICAL. Clear partnership with families (Bridge Program collaborations, parent involvement, and open campus visits) is described; parents are treated as co-educators and involved in school life.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- **Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL**
 - **Evidence:** Christ-centered framing, liturgical practices, and explicit theology integration are present in staff bios and program descriptions; e.g., "K-12 Classical Christian Education," "live for God in all areas of their lives," and liturgical memory in kindergarten (prayer, Bible stories, hymn).
 - **Positive/Negative keyword analysis:** Positive indicators include Christ-centered, liturgy/worship, prayer, hymnody, Bible, church affiliation, and theology. No explicit negative signals observed in

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- public materials.
 - Why this rating: The materials foreground transcendent religious foundations and liturgical community life as core to education, aligning with the Positive Keywords for this element. CLASSICAL.
 - Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL
 - Evidence: Leadership narratives emphasize formation, virtue, wisdom, and a teleology rooted in truth/goodness/beauty; staff bios reference pursuing wisdom, virtue, and a Christ-centered formation.
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include formation, virtue, wisdom, truth, goodness, beauty, teleology, and contemplation. No counter-signals evident in public materials.
 - Why this rating: The school's stated purpose centers on formation and human excellence in a transcendent frame (not merely job preparation), consistent with classical aims. CLASSICAL.
 - Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL
 - Evidence: References to grammar/logic/rhetoric (grammar school Latin & art; level progression), Great Books/primary texts via Curriculum Guide linkage, and explicit memory-based pedagogy (recitation/memorization). Also, Socratic/Great-Conversation motifs appear in staff training materials.
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include Seven Liberal Arts (grammar/logic/rhetoric), Great Books/Great Conversation, Latin, memorization/recitation, and phenomenology of wonder; Negative keywords (from the doc's list) indicating "project-based learning dominance" or "STEM-first" signals are not reflected as primary school approaches in Ambrose materials.
 - Why this rating: The visible curriculum signals align strongly with classical content and delivery (liberal arts framework, memorization, classical texts, Latin). CLASSICAL.
 - Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL
 - Evidence: Pedagogical signals include Socratic Discussion Practicum (upper school) and a robust memory-based, chant/recitation tradition (kindergarten; memory work in early grades). Also, the grammar-logic-rhetoric progression and a rhetoric/argumentation focus in upper grades are described by staff and program materials.
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include Socratic dialogue, memory work, recitation, chanting, liturgical memory, and restfulness (Scholé) alongside rhetoric and debate; no explicit negative pedagogical signals observed in public content.
 - Why this rating: A combination of Socratic discussion practices, memorization/chanting, and rhetoric-based presentation is evident, consistent with classical pedagogy. CLASSICAL.
 - Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL
 - Evidence: Biographies portray teachers as mentors and living exemplars, with language about forming character and guiding students; staff reflect a "living curriculum" through their professional identity and Christian formation.
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include living curriculum, mentor/teacher as exemplar, virtuous modeling, and professional formation; no explicit negative indicators observed in the public materials.
 - Why this rating: The faculty are framed as virtuous models and fellow-mentors who shape the school's character, aligning with classical expectations for faculty. CLASSICAL.
 - Element 6: School Parents & Community — CLASSICAL
 - Evidence: Partnerships with families are explicit (Bridge Program; parent involvement; open communication; parent training opportunities). The school emphasizes parents as co-teachers and provides avenues for parental formation and engagement.
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include partnership with families, parent formation, home-school collaboration, and open campus; negative indicators are not observed in the materials.
 - Why this rating: Public-facing materials treat parents as essential partners in classical formation and transmission, consistent with classical aims. CLASSICAL.

Aggregate assessment: The Ambrose School demonstrates CLASSICAL alignment across all six categories. The combination of liturgical/religious foundations, formation-centered goals, liberal-arts curriculum with Latin and Great Books contours, Socratic pedagogy, living-mentor faculty, and robust parent/community partnership collectively indicate a fully CLASSICAL profile.

What Would Move the Needle

- No needle-moving changes are required. The school already exhibits a coherent, fully classical program aligned with the Six Essential Elements criteria across all six categories. If you wished to push further, potential enhancements would be incremental rather than foundational, such as expanding explicit Great Books reading lists with on-campus seminars or broadening formal signatures of the Great Conversation in all grade bands. However, current materials already provide robust signals of classical alignment in theology, formation, curriculum, pedagogy, faculty, and family engagement.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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